

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Can We Boost The Immune System?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	The immune system works as the body's _____ against illness.
2	Oranges are often chosen because people link them with _____.
3	In winter, some people take _____ to strengthen their body's protection.
4	Another common method is _____, although the programme questions how useful it is.
5	A nasal product was judged no more effective than _____.
6	A popular UK health trend mentioned in the programme is _____.
7	People who do this activity say it benefits their _____.
8	Stress may matter because _____ can make the immune system weaker.
9	A stressed person may become more likely to suffer from _____.
10	The same possible benefit might also come from social activities such as _____.

11 **What is the programme mainly going to examine at the start?**

- A Why winter illnesses have become more serious
- B Whether common immune-boosting habits really help
- C How vitamin C was first discovered
- D Which foods contain the most vitamins

12 **Which group of illnesses is used to show why winter health is a concern?**

- A Allergies, asthma and headaches
- B Food poisoning and stomach problems
- C Skin infections and tiredness
- D Colds, flu and Covid-19

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **What is Margaret McCartney's view of the nasal product mentioned?**
- A It may be interesting, but it is not better than salt-water spray
 - B It is clearly the best way to prevent winter illness
 - C It works only if people also take vitamins
 - D It is dangerous and should not be used
- 14 **What broader point is made about many popular health products?**
- A They are useful only for older adults
 - B They work better when combined with exercise
 - C There is not enough proof that they affect immune function
 - D They are effective because many people buy them
- 15 **What do cold-water swimmers believe about the activity in winter?**
- A It may reduce their chance of becoming ill
 - B It completely prevents colds
 - C It replaces the need for medical treatment
 - D It only helps competitive athletes
- 16 **Why might being with other people help the immune system indirectly?**
- A It exposes people to more germs safely
 - B It makes cold water less dangerous
 - C It increases the amount of vitamin C in the body
 - D It can reduce stress, which may otherwise weaken immunity
- 17 **What can be inferred about stress from John's explanation?**
- A Stress has no connection with illness
 - B Stress may make someone more vulnerable to infection
 - C Stress only affects people who swim in cold water
 - D Stress is always caused by being alone
- 18 **How does John limit his support for cold-water swimming?**
- A He says it is harmful for most people
 - B He says it is useful only in winter
 - C He says similar benefits may come from other activities
 - D He says it works only with medical supervision

19 **In the explanation, what does "dampens" mean when used about the immune system?**

- A Makes it weaker
- B Makes it quicker
- C Makes it more accurate
- D Makes it disappear

20 **What is the final cautious conclusion about cold-water swimming?**

- A Only cold-water swimming can improve winter health
- B It may help through stress reduction, but other activities may do the same
- C It has been proven to stop all winter colds
- D It works mainly because cold water kills viruses